

Staff Induction and Performance Review Policy

Aligned to the RACGP Standards for general practices (6th edition, published August 2026)

1. Policy Title

Staff Induction and Performance Review Policy

2. Purpose

This policy describes how [Practice Name] inducts, supports, and reviews its staff to maintain a competent and engaged team. It aligns with criterion F4 – Induction, training and supporting performance of the RACGP Standards for general practices (6th edition).

3. Scope

This policy applies to all staff on commencement and throughout their employment or engagement at the practice.

4. Definitions

- Induction: The structured process of introducing a new staff member to the practice, their role, and key policies.
- Probation: An initial period of employment during which performance and fit are assessed.
- Performance review: A periodic, documented discussion of performance, development, and goals.
- Continuing professional development (CPD): Ongoing learning that maintains a clinician's competence.
- Family, domestic and sexual violence (FDSV): Abuse and violence covered by the practice's recognition and response framework (criterion F4.C).

5. Principles

- Every staff member receives a structured induction before independent practice.
- Credentials, registrations, and mandatory training are verified at induction and monitored.
- Performance is reviewed at least annually with clear, fair feedback.
- Continuing professional development is supported and documented.
- Equity and respectful conduct are expected of all staff (AHPRA-compliant).

6. Recruitment and Credentialing

- Recruitment follows a documented process including position description, interview, referee checks, and pre-employment screening.
- Credentials and registrations are verified before commencement, including AHPRA registration, working with children check, police check, and immunisation status.
- Right to work in Australia is verified.

7. Induction

- A structured induction covers practice values, organisational structure, role description, key policies, IT systems, emergency procedures, infection control, privacy, and work health and safety.
- Mandatory training is completed during induction (privacy, IPC, manual handling, fire safety, BLS).
- Staff are trained to work within the scope of their role, with role-specific training at commencement and ongoing training to maintain competency (criterion F4.B).
- Staff are made aware of Medicare billing education resources relevant to their role (criterion F4.B).
- All staff receive training in the delivery of person-centred care (criterion F4.B).
- A buddy or mentor is assigned for the first weeks.
- Induction is documented and signed off by the new staff member and Practice Manager.

8. Probation

- Probation lasts for the period specified in the employment contract.
- Probation reviews are held at the midpoint and end of probation.
- Confirmation of employment is documented when probation is satisfactorily completed.

9. Performance Review

- Formal performance reviews are held at least annually.
- Reviews cover performance against the role description, achievements, development goals, and any concerns.
- Reviews are documented and signed by the staff member and reviewer.
- Informal feedback is provided regularly throughout the year.

10. Continuing Professional Development

- All clinical staff maintain CPD in line with their board/college requirements.
- The practice supports CPD through study leave, access to education, and protected time.
- CPD is documented for each staff member.

11. Recognising and Responding to Abuse and Violence (Criterion F4.C)

- The practice adopts recognised guidelines and a practice framework for recognising and responding to abuse and violence, including family, domestic, and sexual violence (FDSV).
- Local referral pathways are available to the practice team to support safe, trauma-informed practice.
- Employed staff complete role-appropriate training in recognising and responding to FDSV.
- The practice obtains reasonable assurance that independent doctors working at the practice have completed role-appropriate FDSV training.
- A consistent team approach is promoted through team discussions, briefings, and access to current resources.
- FDSV training completion is recorded in each staff member's training record.

12. Roles and Responsibilities

Practice Manager:

- Coordinates recruitment, induction, probation, and performance review.
- Maintains staff records and credential registers.

Practice Principal / supervisors:

- Lead performance reviews for their direct reports.

All staff:

- Participate in induction and review.
- Maintain their own CPD and notify the practice of any change to registration.

13. Monitoring, Audit, and Review

- Annual audit of staff files for currency of credentials, registrations, and mandatory training.
- Annual audit of FDSV training completion for employed staff and assurance for independent doctors.
- Annual review of this policy.

14. Documentation and Record Keeping

The practice maintains for each staff member:

- Role description and employment contract.
- Verified credentials, registrations, and checks.
- Induction checklist and sign-off.
- Probation and performance review records.
- Training and CPD records, including FDSV and person-centred care training.
- Immunisation records (confidentially held).

15. References

- The Royal Australian College of General Practitioners. Standards for general practices (6th edition). East Melbourne, Vic: RACGP; published 26 August 2026. Available at: <https://www.racgp.org.au/running-a-practice/practice-standards/standards-6th-edition>
- Medical Board of Australia. Continuing professional development. Available at: <https://www.medicalboard.gov.au>
- Fair Work Ombudsman. Best practice guides. Available at: <https://www.fairwork.gov.au>

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